

Implementation regulations for group evidence of achievement

(Master of Science in Applied Information and Data Science. Version 2022-08-29)

Starting position

Professional practice expects executives to regularly work in smaller and or larger groups. As a university with a practical orientation, our aim is to make our students fit for the employment market and careers in management. We correspondingly attach great importance to evidence showing group achievement. The university is convinced that leadership skills can only be conveyed to a limited extent. It is more to the point that managerial skills must be practiced and lived. Group work is ideally suited to this purpose. These implementation regulations are to ensure that all group members are able to achieve as high a learning effect from group work.

Principles

1. Group evidence of achievement inevitably leads to an identical assessment for all involved group members. A deviating assessment is only permissible if relevant proceedings were initiated by the module leaders or head of the Master's degree programme. This particularly applies if a group member submits the work too late or plagiarism exists.
2. The basis of the group work is a so-called Team Agreement. The Team Agreement regulates the organization of the group meetings, the definition of the group goals and the individual goals, the rules of conduct as well as the project planning with the individual work contributions.
3. It is expected that all group members spend around the same amount of time on the group evidence of achievement.
4. Appeals after submitting the group evidence of achievement are not permissible.

Procedure

If it becomes apparent in the framework of the group work that one or several group members are not providing the necessary performance in the necessary quality, or the behaviour of the group member is obstructing the objective of the group task respective the group project being achieved, in such cases, it is expected from the students that they initiate the following procedure.

Step 1: Internal discussion

The students are required to have an internal discussion. The discussion is to be recorded in writing. Measurable performance respective behavioural targets have to be defined for the group member with whose performance, whose behaviour in the group is not in agreement. The targets are to be reviewed within a maximum of two weeks.

The record is to be signed by all group members and sent to the supervising head coach or lecturer and the relevant responsible module leader.

Step 2: Discussion with the module leader

In cases where no positive change can be ascertained, the group must immediately inform the relevant responsible module leader as well as the head of the Master's degree programme. The responsible module leader must promptly initiate a relevant procedure. To do this the following steps have to be initiated:

1. All group members are given the opportunity to make a written statement. The group members must verify their statement with evidence (e.g., email correspondence).

2. Based on this evidence the relevant responsible module leader will immediately arrange a discussion with the group.
3. Following the discussion, the module leader must take one of the following measures, amongst others (step 3). The measures are to be observed against the background of the remaining processing time of the group assignment and reasonableness.

Step 3: Decision on measures

Measure 1: The module leader defines binding performance and behaviour targets for the group for individual group members. If the targets are not achieved, the group shall be dissolved.

Measure 2: The group is dissolved. A new group composition is formed. Each part group is given an adapted assignment, derived directly from the original assignment. The performance provided up to now by the group may continue to be used by all group members.

Measure 3: One group member (or several) is/are excluded from the group. The excluded group member/s is/are given a new assignment, which has nothing in common with the previously common group assignment.

Measure 4: One or several group members is/are excluded from the group. The performance of the excluded group member/s is/are assessed with the grade 1.0. This measure is then to be taken if no reasonable new assignment can be formulated in the remaining time. It can also be taken if the behaviour and or the performance of the excluded group member fell far short of fulfilling the assignment expectations.

Step 4: Notification of the decision

The module leader informs the group members, other relevant lecturers as well as the head of the Master's programme.

Step 5: Further disciplinary measures

The head of the Master's degree programme may initiate additional disciplinary measures against students who have massively violated group regulations or whose performance is not worthy of a university education.